



(Don't Write
anything in this Area)

- Q7. (a) Briefly describe the factors responsible for decline in marriage in the world and also give anthropological interpretations of live in relationships. (20 marks)

According to Kathleen Gough, "Marriage" is a union between women and one or more individuals such that children born to women; not restricted under the rules of relationship; are given full birth rights and status ^{as} available to other members of society.

Marriage as a social Institution has following functions :-

- Monopoly of spouses over sexual relations.
- Security to the mother-child complex.
- Children ~~are~~ have socially approved father & mother.
- Establishment of conjugal fund for child security.

- Greater social solidarity among kins of 2 families.

Such functions of marriage in today's world are taken over by "other agencies" resulting in decline of marriage as a social institution.

⇒ Physiological needs of sex are fulfilled by live-in relations.

⇒ Secondary social groups are of greater importance than primary social groups. e.g. office group.

⇒ Aspirations to excel in financial and career terms have weakened the foundations of such institution since its considered as "restrictive" on individual aspirations.

- ⇒ Security in society in today's globalised world is taken by numerous welfare programs of government.
- ⇒ Rise of feminist movements and opposition to this institution has resulted in its decline.
- ⇒ Choosing "freedom" & "liberty" of self over "greater kin relations" ~~has~~ can be seen as one of the reasons for its decline.

Anthropological Interpretations of live-in relationship's :-

"live-in relationship's" are relationship's where in 2 adults not bound by rules of marriage; co-habit under one roof & are sexually active.

- ⇒ Such relationship's don't restrict the freedom of spouses as in marriage regulations.
- ⇒ Each spouse is financially independent.
- ⇒ Such relations can be easily dissolved without involvement of society.
- ⇒ Such relations can be considered as reflective of "marriage by probation" in simple societies.

In recent times; Supreme Court has decriminalized "Same-sex" relations thereby ushering in a new era of cultural change. But more than legal acceptance; society needs to accept such relations for better societal acceptance & existence of such relations.